This was a historic nook where the first tea plantations came up in Munnar. John Daniel Munro, British Resident of Travancore, leased vast tracts of land in the Kannan Devan Hills from the Raja of Poonjar and formed the North Travancore Land Planting & Agricultural Society in 1879. The High Ranges of Travancore attracted pioneering planters like A.H. Sharp, Henry Gribble Turner and A.W. Turner. Baron George Otto Von Rosenburg of Dresden started Manale division while his son Baron John Michael added a tennis court! Harrisons Malayalam has leased Lockhart Bungalow to CGH Earth and plans are afoot to hand over the historic Manale Bungalow as well. As forests were cleared for tea, the British set up a hydroelectric project, monorail, ropeway and railways. The changing topography suffered immensely during the great flood of 1924; the centenary celebrations in 2024 hope to raise awareness about the region's fragile ecology.



At Lockhart Bungalow, a three-room British tea plantation bungalow wrapped by a pristine lawn, 1,500 acres seemed a large enough tract to lose oneself in



Chittoor Kottaram looks onto the backwaters